

01

What agricultural geography studies

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

!Primary activities classified by direct dependence on nature

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

!Primary activities classified by direct dependence on nature

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Agricultural geography therefore asks three simple questions:

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

cannot explain the location; water control and incentives complete the answer.

ANSWER LINE: !Primary activities classified by direct dependence on nature

02

The six controls of agriculture

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Fertile soil alone is not sufficient.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

No single control creates an agricultural region.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Think of six filters working together:

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

water, labour or access does not automatically become a productive farming belt.

ANSWER LINE: !Physical and human controls that jointly shape agricultural location

03

Major agricultural systems

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Commercial orientation asks how strongly production is aimed at the market.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

!Farming systems compared by subsistence, labour, scale and market orientation

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Intensity asks how much labour/capital and output occur per unit land.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Intensive does not always mean mechanised.

ANSWER LINE: !Farming systems compared by subsistence, labour, scale and market orientation

04

Von Thunen — why distance still matters

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

The exact classical rings rarely survive today, but the mechanism survives.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Von Thunen imagined one market surrounded by uniform land.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Modern transport and cold chains stretch rather than erase distance effects

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

!Modern transport and cold chains stretch rather than erase distance effects

ANSWER LINE: !Classical Von Thunen rings around a central market

05

World agricultural regions and crop requirements

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

World regions become memorable when each is tied to one climate pattern, one production

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

World regions become memorable when each is tied to one climate pattern, one production

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

system and one market or labour feature.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Crop requirements are broad guides, not rigid thresholds:

ANSWER LINE: !World agricultural regions linked to climate, labour and markets

06

From subsistence to commercialisation

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

A vegetable-growing district can commercialise only when production is matched by roads,

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Institutions matter because they organise water, information and exchange.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Institutions matter because they organise water, information and exchange.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Explain commercialisation as a sequence of linked capabilities, not as a simple shift from

ANSWER LINE: !Inputs, farm decisions, outputs and feedbacks in an agroecosystem

07

Reading agriculture current affairs without data mistakes

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

What is the reference year and unit?

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Agriculture news often places several unlike numbers side by side.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Agriculture news often places several unlike numbers side by side.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

!Official-data status ladder and the labels that must not be collapsed

ANSWER LINE: !Official-data status ladder and the labels that must not be collapsed

08

Non-farm primary activities — the physiography principle

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Primary activities extract or harvest directly from nature.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Their location is tightly constrained because the resource cannot be shifted to any chosen

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Their location is tightly constrained because the resource cannot be shifted to any chosen

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Their location is tightly constrained because the resource cannot be shifted to any chosen

ANSWER LINE: Primary activities extract or harvest directly from nature.

09

Fishing

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Fishing geography depends on the width and depth of the continental shelf, nutrient supply,

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Link every example to a mechanism: shelf -> marine potential; floodplain/reservoir -> inland

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Mangrove-estuarine margins are nursery habitats but can also face aquaculture pressure.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

floodplains and peninsular reservoirs also show why a major fish-producing area need not be

ANSWER LINE: Fishing geography depends on the width and depth of the continental shelf, nutrient supply,

10

Forestry and forest produce

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Forestry is controlled not only by the existence of trees but by species, slope, distance and

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Forestry is controlled not only by the existence of trees but by species, slope, distance and

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Diverse tropical forests are also less suited to uniform mechanised extraction than

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Forestry is controlled not only by the existence of trees but by species, slope, distance and

ANSWER LINE: Forestry is controlled not only by the existence of trees but by species, slope, distance and

11

Mining and quarrying

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Write geology -> occurrence -> accessibility -> extraction -> social/ecological consequence.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Geology decides occurrence, while grade, relief, transport, power and processing decide

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Quarrying may be widespread, but riverbed mining and hill cutting can destabilise channels and

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Mineral richness does not guarantee local prosperity.

ANSWER LINE: Geology decides occurrence, while grade, relief, transport, power and processing decide

12

Core exam map

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Prelims: farming-system distinctions; crop-climate links; Von Thunen; primary-activity

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

classification; official-data labels.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

GS-I: world agricultural regions; location models; physiography of non-farm primary

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Prelims: farming-system distinctions; crop-climate links; Von Thunen; primary-activity

ANSWER LINE: Prelims: farming-system distinctions; crop-climate links; Von Thunen; primary-activity